

### 0.0.1 Janavasabha

janavasabhasuttam

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Natika at the Brick Hall. At that time, at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

evam me sutam: ekam samayam bhagavaṃ nātike<sup>1</sup>  
viharati giṇṇakāvasathe. tena kho pana samayena  
bhagavaṃ parito parito janapadesu paricārake ab-

bhatīte kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti, kāsikosa-  
 lesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu<sup>2</sup> kurupañcālesu mac-  
 chasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra  
 upapanno ti. paropaññāsaṃ nātikiyā paricārakā  
 abbhatītā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ  
 saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha pari-  
 nibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā  
 navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā tiṇ-  
 ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgadosamohānaṃ  
 tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva<sup>3</sup> imaṃ lokam āgan-  
 tvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañca-  
 satāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā, tiṇ-  
 ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avini-  
 pātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti.

2. The [Natika people] heard of the Natika disciples:  
 Apparently at each and every place within the country,  
 the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who  
 had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the  
 Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the  
 Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the  
 Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.”  
 “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and  
 passed away, from the complete extinction of the five  
 fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born  
 spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that  
 place, not subject to return from that world. More than  
 ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed  
 away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters

and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

assosum kho nātikiyā paricārakā: bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhātite kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrase-  
nesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno’ti.  
paropaññāsaṃ nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgadosamohānaṃ tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā”ti. tena ca nātikiyā paricārakā attamanā ahesum pamuditā pītisomanas-sajātā bhagavato pañhaveyyākaraṇaṃ<sup>4</sup> sutvā.

3. The venerable Ananda heard: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

assosi kho āyasmā ānando: bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhātīte kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti. kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno ti. paro-

paññāsanātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā pañcannam orambhāgiyānam saññojanānam parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇam saññojanānam parikkhayā rāgadosamohānam tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti, sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇam saññojanānam parikkhayā sotāpunnā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti. tena ca nātikiyā paricārakā attamanā ahesuṃ pamuditā pītisomanassajātā bhagavato pañhaveyyākaraṇam sutvā”ti.

4. Then this occurred to the venerable Ananda: “But there were also these Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

atha kho āyasmato ānandassa etadahosi: ime kho panāpi<sup>1</sup> ahesuṃ māgadhakā paricārakā bahū ceva

rattaññū ca abbhatītā kālakatā. suññā maññe aṅ-  
gamagadhā aṅgamāgadhakehi<sup>2</sup> paricārakehi ab-  
bhatītehi kālakatehi. te kho panāpi ahesuṃ bud-  
dhe pasannā dhamme pasannā saṅghe pasannā  
sīlesu paripūrakārino te abbhatītā kālakatā bha-  
gavatā abyākatā. tesampassa<sup>3</sup> sādhu veyyākara-  
ṇaṃ. bahunā pasādeyya tato gaccheyya suga-  
tiṃ.

5. Also this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing his praises: “That righteous lawful king, having brought us so much happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king’s kindom.” Yet, he too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [his birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of him. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn’t the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away,

that would be a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn't the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?"

ayaṃ kho paṇāpi ahosi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro dhammiko dhammarājā hito brāhmaṇagahapatikānaṃ negamānañceva jānapadānañca. apissudaṃ manussā kittayamānarūpā viharanti 'evaṃ no so dhammiko dhammarājā sukhāpetvā kālakato, evaṃ mayaṃ tassa dhammikassa dhammarāṇṇo vijite phāsu<sup>4</sup> viharimhā'ti. so kho paṇāpi ahosi buddhe pasanno dhamme pasanno saṅghe pasanno sīlesu paripūrakārī. apissudaṃ manussā evamāhaṃsu 'yāva maraṇakālāpi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro bhagavantam kittayamānarūpo kālakato'ti. so abbhatīto kālakato bhagavatā abyākato. tassa passa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ. bahu-jano pasīdeyya, tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ. bhagavato kho pana sambodhi magadhesu. yattha kho bhagavato sambodhi magadhesu, kathaṃ tattha bhagavā māgadhake paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu na byākareyya? bhagavā ceva kho pana māgadhake paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu na byākareyya dīnamanā tenassu māgadhakā paricārakā. yena kho panassu dīnamanā māgadhakā paricārakā kathaṃ te bhagavā na byākareyyāti.

6. The venerable Ananda, having pondered over this [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples, having risen during the night before dawn, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Ananda said this to the Auspicious One:

idamāyasmā ānando māgadhake paricārake ārab-  
bha eko raho anuvicintetvā rattiyā paccūsasama-  
yaṃ paccuṭṭhāya yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami.  
upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantaṃ abhivādetvā ekaman-  
taṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho āyasmā ānando  
bhagavantaṃ etadavoca:

7. This, O Bhante, was heard by me: “Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction



of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.”

sutammetam bhante bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapat-tīsu byākaroti kāsikosalesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu. asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno ti. paropaññāsam nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhikā navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgadosamohānaṃ tanuttā sakadāgāmino sakideva imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇāti. tena ca nātikiyā paricārakā attamanā ahesuṃ pamuditā pītisomanassajātā bhagavato pañhaveyyākaraṇaṃ sutvāti.

8. But there were also these Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

ime kho panāpi bhante ahesuṃ māgadhakā paricārakā bahū ceva rattaññū ca abbhātītā kālakatā suññā maññe aṅgamagadhā aṅgamāgadha-kehi paricārakehi abbhātītehi kālakatehi. te kho panāpi bhante ahesuṃ buddhe pasannā dhamme pasannā saṅghe pasannā sīlesu paripūrakārino. te abbhātītā kālakatā bhagavatā abyākatā. te sampassa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ bahujaṇo pasādeyya tato gaccheyya sugatīṃ.

9. Also, O Bhante, this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing his praises: “That righteous lawful king, having brought us so much happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king’s kingdom.” Yet, he too had

confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] has died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [his birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of him. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn't the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, that would be a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn't the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?"

ayaṃ kho panāpi bhante, ahosi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro dhammiko dhammarājā hito brāhmaṇagahapatikānaṃ negamānañceva jānapadānañca. apissudaṃ manussā kittayamānarūpā viharanti. 'evaṃ no so dhammiko dhammarājā sukhāpetvā kālakato, evaṃ mayaṃ tassa dhammikassa dhammarañño vijite phāsu viharimhā'ti. so kho panāpi bhante, ahosi buddhe pasanno dhamme pasanno saṅghe pasanno sīlesu paripūrakārī. apissudaṃ manussā evamāhaṃsu 'yāva maraṇakālā pi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro bhagavantaṃ kittayamānarūpo kālakato'ti. so abbatito kāla-

kato bhagavatā abyākato, tassa passa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ bahujaṇo pasīdeyya tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ, bhagavato kho pana bhante, sambodhi magadhesu. yattha kho pana bhante, bhagavato sambodhi magadhesu kathaṃ tattha bhagavā māgadhake paricārake abbatthāte kālakate upapattisu na byākareyya. bhagavā ce kho pana bhante, māgadhake paricārake abbatthāte kālakate upapattisu na byākareyya, dīnamanā 1 tenassu māgadhakā paricārakā. yena kho panassu bhante, dīnamanā māgadhakā paricārakā, kathaṃ te bhagavā na byākareyyā”ti.

10. The venerable Ananda, having made this suggestion regarding the Magadhan disciples in front of the Auspicious One, having risen up from his seat, having bowed down, having circumambulated the Auspicious One, he departed.

idamāyasmā ānando māgadhake paricārake ārabha bhagavato sammukhā parikathaṃ katvā utthāyāsanā bhagavantam abhivādetvā padakkhiṇaṃ katvā pakkāmi.

11. Then the Auspicious One, not long after the venerable Ananda had left, having dressed in the morning, having taken bowl and robe, entered Natika for alms food. Having wandered in Natika for alms food, after his meal, having gone back after alms gathering, having

washed his feet, having entered the Brick Hall, having made the [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples his aim, having attended to it with all his mind, he sat down on a prepared seat [thinking]: “I will find out the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy ones, that which is their destiny, their after-death state.” “The Auspicious One saw the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy Magadhan disciples.” Then in the evening, the Auspicious One, having emerged from seclusion, having gone out of the Brick Hall, sat down on a prepared seat in the shade of the dwelling.

atha kho bhagavā acirapakkante āyasmante ānande pubbanhasamayam nivāsetvā pattacīvaramādāya nātikaṃ piṇḍāya pāvīsi. nātike piṇḍāya caritvā pacchābhaddham piṇḍapātapaṭikkanto pāde pakkhāletvā giṇṇakāvasatham pavisitvā māgadhake paricārake ārabha aṭṭhikatvā manasi katvā sabbam cetesā samannāharitvā paññatte āsane nisīdi “gatiṃ tesam jānissāmi abhisamparāyam yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyā”ti. addasā kho bhagavā māgadhake paricārake yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyāti. atha kho bhagavā sāyanhasamayam paṭisallānā vuṭṭhito giṇṇakāvasathā nikkhamitvā vihārapacchāyāyam paññatte āsane nisīdi.

12. Then the venerable Ananda approached the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the

Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Ananda said this to the Auspicious One: “The Auspicious One, O Bhante, has a peaceful appearance, for the Auspicious One’s facial complexion is bright, showing clearness of the faculties. Surely, O Bhante, the Auspicious One dwelled in a peaceful abiding today.”

atha kho āyasmā ānando yena bhagavā tenupa-saṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho āyasmā ānando bhagavantam etadavoca. “upa-santapadisso<sup>1</sup> bhante bhagavā, bhātiriva bhagavato mukhavaṇṇo vipprasannattā indriyānaṃ. santena nūnajja bhante bhagavā vihārena vihāsī”ti.

13. “Just that which you, O Ananda, having made the suggestion regarding the Magadhan disciples in front of me, having risen up from your seat, and departed, it is thus, that I, having wandered in Natika for alms food, after my meal, having gone back after alms gathering, having washed my feet, having entered the Brick Hall, having made the [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples my aim, having attended to it with all my mind, I sat down on a prepared seat [thinking]: “I will find out the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy ones, that which is their destiny, their after-death state.” “I saw the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy Magadhan disciples.”

“yadeva kho me tvam ānanda, māgadhake paricā-  
 rake ārabba sammukhā parikathaṃ katvā utthā-  
 yāsanā pakkanto, tadevāhaṃ nātike piṇḍāya ca-  
 ritvā pacchābhataṃ piṇḍapātaṭṭhikkanto pāde  
 pakkhāletvā giṇṇakāvasathaṃ pavisitvā māgadhake  
 paricārake ārabba aṭṭhikavā<sup>2</sup> manasi katvā sab-  
 baṃ cetesā samannāharitvā paññatte āsane ni-  
 sīdiṃ ‘gatiṃ tesam jānissāmi abhisamparāyaṃ,  
 yaṃgatiṃ te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyā’ti. ad-  
 dasaṃ kho ahaṃ ānanda, māgadhake paricārake  
 yaṃgatiṃ te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyāti.

14. Then O Ananda, an invisible Yakkha announced aloud: “I am Janavasabha, O Auspicious One, I am Janavasabha, O Well-farer.” Have you, O Ananda, not known or heard [anyone] from here who formerly bore such a name, that is “Janavasabha?”

atha kho ānanda, antarahito yakkho saddamanu-  
 sāvesi: ‘janavasabho ahaṃ bhagavā, janavasabho  
 ahaṃ sugatā’ti. “abhijānāsi no tvam ānanda, ito  
 pubbe evarūpaṃ nāmadheyyaṃ sutam yadidaṃ  
 janavasabho”ti.

15. “I, O Bhante, have not known or heard [anyone] from here who formerly bore such a name, that is Janavasabha?” Nevertheless, O Bhante, my body hair stood up, having heard of a bearer of the name, “Janavasabha.” Of me, O Bhante, this occurred: “Surely indeed, whoever bears

this well-declared name, that is, “Janavasabha,” will not be a low ranking Yakkha.”

“na kho ahaṃ bhante, abhijānāmi ito pubbe evarūpaṃ nāmadheyyaṃ sutāṃ yadidaṃ janavasabho”ti. api ca me bhante, lomāni haṭṭhāni janavasabho ti nāmadheyyaṃ sutvā. tassa mayhaṃ bhante, etadahosi: na hi nūna so orako yakkho bhavissati yassidaṃ<sup>3</sup> evarūpaṃ nāmadheyyaṃ supaññattaṃ yadidaṃ janavasabho’ti.

16. Immediately, O Ananda, after the manifestation of the sound, a Yakkha of extraordinary beauty appeared in front of me. Also for a second time he announced aloud: “I am Bimbisara, O Auspicious One, I am Bimbisara, O Well-farer.” “This, O Bhante, is the seventh time that I have arisen in companionship with the great king Vessavana. I passed away from there as a king of human beings to come into being [here]. Seven from here, seven from there, I know fourteen abodes of wandering on, where my former abodes were. For a long time, O Bhante, I have known myself to be one free from the lower worlds, not liable to be born in the lower worlds, and the desire has arisen in me to be settled in once-returnership.”

“anantarā kho ānanda, saddapātubhāvā ulāravaṇṇo me yakkho sammukhe pāturahosi. dutiyampi sad-damanussāvesi: ‘bimbisāro ahaṃ bhagavā bimbisāro ahaṃ sugatā’ti. idaṃ sattamaṃ kho ahaṃ



bhante, vessavaṇassa mahārājassa sahabyataṃ upapajjāmi. so tato cuto manussarājā bhavituṃ pahomi.<sup>4</sup> ito satta tato satta saṃsārāni catuddasa, nivāsamabhijānāmi yattha me vusitaṃ pure. dīgharattaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, avinipāto avinipātaṃ sañjānāmi. āsā ca pana me santiṭṭhati saka-dāgāmitāyā ti.

17. “This is magnificent of the venerable Yakkha Janavasabha, this is unprecedented of the venerable Yakkha Janavasabha that you say: “For a long time, O Bhante, I have known myself to be one free from the lower worlds, not liable to be born in the lower worlds, and the desire has arisen in me to be settled in once-returnership.” But from where as the source does the venerable Yakkha Janavasabha know of such a great attainment of distinction?”

“acchariyamidaṃ āyasmato janavasabhassa yakkhassa, abbhutamidaṃ āyasmato janavasabhassa yakkhassa. ‘dīgharattaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, avinipāto avinipātaṃ sañjānāmīti ca vadesi, āsā ca pana me santiṭṭhati sakadāgāmitāyāti ca vadesi. kuto nidānaṃ panāyasmā janavasabho yakkho eva-rūpaṃ ulāraṃ visesādhigamaṃ sañjānātī?’ti.

18. Not apart from your instructions, O Auspicious One, not apart from your instructions, O Well-farer. Since the day, O Bhante, I attained the higher faith of certainty in the Auspicious One, since then I, O Bhante, have known

for a long time to be one free from the lower worlds, not liable to be born in the lower worlds, and the desire has arisen in me to be settled in once-returnership. Here, O Bhante, I was sent by the great king Vessavana to the presence of the great king, Virulha on some celestial business. On the way, I saw that the Auspicious One, having entered the Brick Hall, having made the [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples his aim, having attended to it with all his mind, he sat down on a prepared seat [thinking]: “I will find out the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy ones, that which is their destiny, their after-death state.” But this, O Bhante, is not a wonder, in that I heard this in the presence of the great king Vessavana’s assembly, I learned this in his presence when he spoke about the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy Magadhan disciples.” Of me, O Bhante, this occurred: “I must see the Auspicious One and I will inform this to the Auspicious One.” These, O Bhante, are the two reasons for me having approached to see the Auspicious One.

“na aññattha bhagavā tava sāsana, na aññattha sugata tava sāsana. yadagge ahaṃ bhante, bhagavati ekantikato<sup>1</sup> abhippasanno, tadagge ahaṃ bhante, dīgharattaṃ avinipāto avinipātaṃ sañjānāmi. āsā ca pana me santiṭṭhati sakadāgāmitāya. idhāhaṃ bhante, vessavaṇena mahārājena pesito virūlhakassa mahārājassa santike kenaci devakaraṇīyena. addasaṃ bhagavantaṃ antarāmagge giṇjakāvasathaṃ pavisitvā māgadha ke pa-

ricārake ārabba aṭṭhikatvā manasikatvā sabbam cetesā samannāharitvā nisinnaṃ ‘gatiṃ tesam jānissāmi abhisamparāyaṃ yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyāti. anacchariyaṃ kho panetaṃ bhante, yaṃ vessavaṇassa mahārājassa tassaṃ parisāyaṃ bhāsato sammukhā sutam sammukhā paṭiggahitaṃ yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyāti. tassa mayhaṃ bhante, etadahosi: bhagavantañca dakkhāmi. idañca bhagavato āroces-sāmīti. ime kho me bhante, dve paccayā bhagavantam dassanāya upasaṅkamituṃ.

19. Formerly, O Bhante, in earlier days, during the Uposatha day, the night of the fifteenth full moon day, at the beginning of the rains retreat, the entire devas of the Tavatimsa, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, the great assembly of devas was seated all around. All of them having assembled, were seated together. The four great kings, sat in the four directions; with the great king Dhatarattha seated in the eastern direction facing west, with the devas in front; the great king Virulha seated in the southern direction facing north, with the devas in front; the great king Virupakkha seated in the western direction facing east, with the devas in front; the great king Vessavana seated in the northern direction facing south, with the devas in front. When, O Bhante, the entire devas of the Tavatimsa, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, the great assembly of devas was seated all around. All of them having assembled, are seated

together, and the four great kings having sat in the four directions, for them this is how they are seated. Then behind them come our seats. Those devas, O Bhante, who having fared the life of purity under the Auspicious One, have recently arisen in this Tavatimsa group, those simply outshine other devas in beauty and glory. By that indeed, O Bhante, the Tavatimsa devas, being pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness [declared], “Verily, dear Sir, the celestial group is increasing, the asurā group is declining.” Then, O Bhante, Sakka, ruler of the devas, having known the satisfaction of the Tavatimsa devas, rejoiced with these verses:

purimāni bhante, divasāni purimatarāni tadahu-  
posathe paṇṇarase vassūpanāyikāya puṇṇāya puṇ-  
ṇamāya rattiya kevalakappā ca devā tāvatimsā  
sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnā honti san-  
nipatitā, mahatī ca dibbaparisā<sup>2</sup> samantato san-  
nisinnā honti<sup>3</sup> sannipatitā. cattāro ca mahārā-  
jāno catuddisā nisinnā honti. puratthimāya di-  
sāya dhatarattho mahārājā pacchimābhimukho<sup>4</sup>  
nisinno hoti deve purakkhatvā. dakkhiṇāya di-  
sāya virūlhako mahārājā uttarābhimukho nisinno  
hoti deve purakkhatvā. pacchimāya disāya virū-  
pakkho mahārājā puratthābhimukho<sup>5</sup> nisinno hoti  
deve purakkhatvā. uttarāya disāya vessavaṇo ma-  
hārājā dakkhiṇābhimukho nisinno hoti deve pu-  
rakkhatvā. yadā bhante, kevalakappā ca devā  
tāvatimsā sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnā  
honti sannipatitā mahatī ca dibbaparisā saman-

tato sannisinnā honti sannipatitā, cattāro ca mahārājāno catuddisā nisinnā honti. idaṃ tesam hoti āsanasmim. atha pacchā amhākaṃ āsanaṃ hoti. ye te bhante, devā bhagavati brahmacariyaṃ caritvā adhunūpapannā tāvatimsakāyaṃ, te aññe deve atirocanti vaṇṇena ceva yasasā ca. tenassudaṃ bhante, devā tāvatimsā attamanā honti pamuditā pītisomanassajātā, “dibbā vata bho kāyā paripūranti hāyanti asurā kāyā”ti. atha kho bhante, sakko devānamindo devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ sampasādaṃ veditvā imāhi gāthāhi anumodi:

Indeed, dear Sir, the Tavatimsa devas rejoice,  
together with their ruler;  
revering the Tathagata,  
and the excellence of the Dhamma.

modanti vata bho devā,  
tāvatimsā sahindakā<sup>1</sup>;  
tathāgataṃ namassantā,  
dhammassa ca sudhammataṃ.

Seeing new devas,  
endowed with beauty and glory;  
having fared the life of purity,  
have come here to a good birth.

nave deve ca passantā,  
vaṇṇavante yasassine,<sup>2</sup>  
sugatasmim brahmacariyaṃ,

caritvāna idhāgate.

They outshining others,  
with beauty and with glory;  
disciples of extensive wisdom,  
distinguished here.

te aññe atirocanti,  
vaṇṇena yasasāyunā;  
sāvaka bhūripaññassa,  
visesūpagatā idha.

Having seen this, Tavatimsa rejoice,  
together with their ruler;  
revering the Tathagata,  
and the excellence of the Dhamma.

idaṃ disvāna nandanti,  
tāvatimsā sahindakā;  
tathāgataṃ namassantā,  
dhammassa ca sudhammatanti.

20. From that indeed, O Bhante, the Tavatimsa devas, being even more pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness [declared], “Verily, dear Sir, the celestial group is increasing, the asurā group is declining.”

tena sudaṃ bhante, devā tāvatimsā bhiyyosomat-  
tāya attamanā honti pamuditā pītisomanassajātā  
‘dibbā vata bho kāyā paripūranti hāyanti asurā

kāyā'ti.

21. Then, O Bhante, the Tavatimsa devas, having deliberated the purpose for which they have assembled at the Sudhamma hall, [for which] the great assembly of devas was seated all around, having discussed that purpose, they informed the four great kings about the meaning of what was said. The four great kings having been informed of the meaning of what was said, each stood by his own seat, not having departed.

atha kho bhante, yenatthena devā tāvatimsā sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnā honti sannipatitā, taṃ atthaṃ cintayitvā taṃ atthaṃ mantayitvā vuttavacanāpi taṃ<sup>3</sup> cattāro mahārājāno tasmim atthe honti. paccanusitthavacanāpi<sup>4</sup> taṃ cattāro mahārājāno tasmim atthe honti, sakesu sakesu āsanesu ṭhitā avipakkantā.<sup>5</sup>

“Those kings being informed of what was said,

received the instructions;  
serene in mind, at peace,  
standing by their own seats.”

“te vuttavākyā rājāno,  
paṭiggayhānusāsanim;  
vippasannamanā santā,  
aṭṭhaṃsu samhi āsane”ti.

22. Then, O Bhante, from the northern quarter a vast light emerged, a radiance became manifest, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas. Then, O Bhante, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed the Tavatimsa devas. “When, dear Sirs, that sign is seen, emergence of a vast light, manifestation of a radiance [it indicates that] Brahma will appear. Indeed this is the foresign of the appearance of Brahma, that is the emergence of light, the manifestation of radiance.”

atha kho bhante, uttarāya disāya uḷāro āloko sañjāyī, obhāso pāturahosi, atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. atha kho bhante, sakko devānamindo deve tāvatimse āmantesi. yathā kho mārisā nimittāni dissanti uḷāro āloko sañjāyati. obhāso pātubhavati, brahmā pātubhavissati, brahmuno hetam pubbanimittam pātubhāvāya yadidaṃ āloko sañjāyati obhāso pātubhavatī ti.

“When the sign is seen,  
Brahma will appear;  
Indeed, this is the sign of Brahma,  
a great and vast radiance.”

“yathā nimittā dissanti,  
brahmā pātubhavissati;  
brahmuno hetam nimittam,  
obhāso vipulo mahāti.”

23. So then, O Bhante, each one of the Tavatimsa devas



sat in his own seat [thinking]: “We will find out what the result of this radiance will be, only having realized that will we go.” The four great kings too, each one sat in his own seat [thinking]: “We will find out what the result of this radiance will be, only having realized that will we go.” Having heard this, the Tavatimsa devas entered upon one accord [thinking]: “We will find out what the result of this radiance will be, only having realized that will we go.”

atha kho bhante, devā tāvatimsā yathāsakesu āsanesu nisīdiṃsu ‘obhāsametaṃ ñassāma yaṃvipāko bhavissati sacchikatvā’va naṃ gamissāmā ti. cat-tāro pi mahārājāno yathāsakesu āsanesu nisīdiṃsu “obhāsametaṃ ñassāma yaṃvipāko bhavissati, sacchikatvā’va naṃ gamissāmā”ti. idaṃ sutvā devā tāvatimsā ekaggā samāpajjiṃsu “obhāsametaṃ ñassāma, yaṃvipāko bhavissati, sacchikatvā’va naṃ gamissāmā”ti.

24. When, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, he appears having created a gross self-begetting, since, O Bhante, Brahma’s natural appearance is imperceivable to the Tavatimsa devas range of vision. When, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, he simply outshines other devas in beauty and glory. Just as, O Bhante, a figure of gold outshines the figure of a human, so too, O Bhante, when Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, he

simply outshines other devas in beauty and glory. When, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, no deva in that assembly bows down to him, or rises from his seat, or offer him a seat. They all simply sit down quietly in cross-legged position with hands in anjali [thinking]: “Now of whichever deva Brahma Sanankumara will wish, he will sit on that deva’s seat.” And of the deva, O Bhante, whose seat Brahma Sanankumara sits down, that deva gains the attainment of a great feeling, that deva gains the attainment of great joy. Just as, O Bhante, a head-anointed Khattiya king being coronated gains the attainment of a great feeling, gains the attainment of great joy, so too, O Bhante, that deva gains the attainment of a great feeling, that deva gains the attainment of great joy.

yadā bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati oḷārikaṃ attabhāvaṃ abhinimminivā pātubhavati. yo kho pana bhante, brahmuno pakativaṇṇo, anabhisambhavanīyo so devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ cakkhupathasmiṃ. yadā bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati so aññe deve atirocati vaṇṇena ceva yasasā ca. seyyathāpi bhante, sovaṇṇo viggaho mānusaṃ viggahaṃ atirocati, evameva kho bhante yadā brahmā sanāṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati, so aññe deve atirocati vaṇṇena ceva yasasā ca. yadā bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati, na tassaṃ parisāyaṃ koci devo abhivādeti vā paccuṭ-

ṭhethi vā āsanena vā nimanteti. sabbeva tuṇhī-  
 bhūtā pañjalikā pallaṅkena nisīdanti 'yassadā'ni  
 devassa icchissati brahmā sanamkumāro tassa de-  
 vassa pallaṅke nisīdissatī'ti. yassa kho pana bhante,  
 devassa brahmā sanamkumāro pallaṅke nisīdati,  
 ulāraṃ so labhati devo vedapaṭilābhaṃ ulāraṃ  
 so labhati devo somanassapaṭilābhaṃ. seyyathāpi  
 bhante, rājā khattiyo muddhāvasitto adhunābhi-  
 sitto rajjena, ulāraṃ so labhati vedapaṭilābhaṃ,  
 ulāraṃ so labhati somanassapaṭilābhaṃ, evameva  
 kho bhante, yassa devassa brahmā sanamkumāro  
 pallaṅke nisīdati ulāraṃ so labhati devo vedapa-  
 ṭilābhaṃ. ulāraṃ so labhati devo somanassapaṭi-  
 lābhaṃ.

25. Then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having cre-  
 ated a gross self-begetting having taken on the appear-  
 ance of the young boy Pancasikha, appeared to the Tava-  
 timsa devas. He, having flown up into the air, sat down  
 cross-legged in the air. Just as, O Bhante, a strong man  
 might easily spread out his crossed legs evenly or sit down  
 on the ground cross-legged, so too, O Bhante, Brahma  
 Sanankumara, having flown up into the air, sat down  
 cross-legged in the air. Having known the satisfaction of  
 the Tavatimsa devas, he rejoiced with these verses:

atha bhante, brahmā sanamkumāro olārikaṃ at-  
 tabhāvaṃ abhinimminivā kumāravaṇṇī hutvā pañ-  
 casikho devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pāturahosi. so

vehāsaṃ abbhuggantvā ākāse antaḷikkhe pallaṅ-  
 kena nisīdi. seyyathāpi bhante, balavā puriso su-  
 paccatthate vā pallaṅke same vā bhūmibhāge pal-  
 laṅkena nisīdeyya, evameva kho bhante, brahmā  
 sanaṃkumāro vehāsaṃ abbhuggantvā ākāse an-  
 taḷikkhe pallaṅkena nisīditvā devānaṃ tāvatiṃ-  
 sānaṃ sampasādaṃ veditvā imāhi gāthāhi anu-  
 modi:

Indeed, dear Sir, the Tavatimsa devas rejoice,  
 together with their ruler;  
 revering the Tathagata,  
 and the excellence of the Dhamma.

modanti vata bho devā,  
 tāvatiṃsā sahindakā<sup>1</sup>;  
 tathāgataṃ namassantā,  
 dhammassa ca sudhammataṃ.

Seeing new devas,  
 endowed with beauty and glory;  
 having fared the life of purity,  
 have come here to a good birth.

nave deve ca passantā,  
 vaṇṇavante yasassine,<sup>2</sup>  
 sugatasmim brahmacariyaṃ,  
 caritvāna idhāgate.

They outshining others,

with beauty and with glory;  
disciples of extensive wisdom,  
distinguished here.

te aññe atirocanti,  
vaṇṇena yasaṣāyunā;  
sāvakaḥ bhūripaññaṣṣa,  
viseṣūpagatā idha.

Having seen this, Tavatimsa rejoice,  
together with their ruler;  
revering the Tathagata,  
and the excellence of the Dhamma.

idaṃ disvāna nandanti,  
tāvatiṃsā sahindakā;  
tathāgataṃ namassantā,  
dhammassa ca sudhammatanti.

26. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. As, O Bhante, the Brahma Sanankumara was speaking this meaning, the sound was endowed with eight factors: It was distinct and intelligible, sweet and lovely to hear, rich and not discordant, deep and melodious, yet, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara's voice was audible to the extent of the assembly. His voice did not pass on outside of the assembly. He whose voice, O Bhante, is thus endowed with eight factors, is said to have the "voice of Brahma." Then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having created a self-begotten of thirty

three [Pancasikhas], having sat down cross-legged individually by each of the Tavatimsa devas, addressed the Tavatimsa devas:

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā saṇḍakumāro bhā-sittha. idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmuno saṇḍakumārassa bhāsato aṭṭhaṅgasamannāgato saro hoti: vissatṭho ca viññeyyo ca mañju ca savaṇīyo ca bindu ca avisārī ca gambhīro ca ninnādī ca. ya-thāparisaṃ kho pana bhante, brahmā saṇḍakumāro sareṇa viññāpeti. na cassa bahiddhā parisāya ghoso niccharati. yassa kho pana bhante, evaṃ aṭṭhaṅgasamannāgato saro hoti, so vuccati ‘brahmassaro’ti. atha kho bhante, brahmā saṇḍakumāro tetṭimsa attabhāve abhinimminivā devānaṃ tāvatiṃsānaṃ paccekapallaṅkesu paccekapallaṅkena nisīditvā deve tāvatiṃse āmantesi:

27. “What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the Auspicious One has treaded on the path for the welfare of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, for the benefit, welfare and happiness of devas and humans. Indeed Sirs, whoever has gone to the Buddha as refuge, gone to the Dhamma as refuge, gone to the Sangha as refuge, and has fulfilled the virtues, with the breakup of the body after death, some have arisen in the companionship of the Paranimmitavasavatti devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Nimmanarati

devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Tusita devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Yama devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Tavatimsa devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Four Great Kings. Those who have fulfilled the very lowest, fill up the host of gandhabbas.”

“taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā. yāvañca so bhagavā bahujanahitāya paṭipanno bahujanasukhāya lokānukampāya atthāya hitāya sukhāya devamanussānaṃ. ye hi keci bho buddhaṃ saraṇaṃ gatā dhammaṃ saraṇaṃ gatā saṅghaṃ saraṇaṃ gatā sīlesu paripūrakārino, te kāyassa bhedā parammaraṇā appekacce paranimmitta-savattīnaṃ devānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ upapajjanti appekacce nimmānaratīnaṃ devānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ upapajjanti, appekacce tusitānaṃ devānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ upapajjanti, appekacce yāmānaṃ devānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ upapajjanti, appekacce tāvatimsānaṃ devānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ upapajjanti, appekacce cātummahārājikānaṃ devānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ upapajjanti, ye sabbanihīnaṃ kāyaṃ paripūrenti, te gandhabbakāyaṃ paripūrenti ti.

28. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. As, O Bhante, the Brahma Sanankumara was speaking this meaning, the devas conceived only his voice [thinking]: “Whoever is seated on my seat speak this to me alone.”

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanamkumāro bhā-  
sitta. idamatthaṃ bhante brahmuno sanamku-  
mārassa bhāsato ghoso yeva. devā maññanti yvā-  
yaṃ mama pallaṅke, svāyaṃ eko'va bhāsatī'ti.

When one is speaking,  
all the creations speaks;  
when one is being silent,  
they all become silent.

“ekasmiṃ bhāsamānasmiṃ,  
sabbe bhāsanti nimmitā;  
ekasmiṃ tuṇhimāsīne,  
sabbe tuṇhībhavanti te.

Then even the Tavatimsa devas,  
together with their ruler conceive;  
whoever is seated on my seat,  
speak this to me alone.”

tadā su devā maññanti,  
tāvatimsā sahindakā;  
yvāyaṃ mama pallaṅkasmiṃ,  
svāyaṃ eko'va bhāsatī ti.”

29. Then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara brought together [those creations] into one. Having brought together [those creations] into one, having sat down cross-legged on Sakka's seat, he addressed the Tavatimsa devas:



atha kho bhante, brahmā sanamkumāro ekattena attānaṃ upasaṃhāsi. ekattena attānaṃ upasaṃharitvā sakkassa devānamindassa pallaṅke pallaṅkena nisīditvā deve tāvatimse āmantesi:

30. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the declaration of the four bases for superhuman powers has been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the possession of superhuman powers, for the mastery of superhuman powers, for the versatility of superhuman powers. Which four?

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā yāvasupaññattā cime tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena cattāro iddhipādā paññattā iddhipahutāya iddhivisavitāya iddhivikubbanatāya. katame cattāro?

31. Here Sirs, a bhikkhu enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with desire-samadhi and the will-power for exertion. He enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with energy-samadhi and the will-power for exertion. He enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with samadhi-state-of-mind and the will-power for exertion. He enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with investigation-samadhi and the will-power for exertion. These, Sirs, are the four bases for superhuman powers that has been

well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the possession of superhuman powers, for the mastery of superhuman powers, for the versatility of superhuman powers. Indeed Sirs, whatever samanas or brahmanas in the past excercised the various kinds of superhuman powers, all those did so only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers. Also whatever samanas or brahmanas in the future will excercise the various kinds of superhuman powers, all those will do so only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers. Also whatever samanas or brahmanas at present excercise the various kinds of superhuman powers, all those do so only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers.

idha bho bhikkhu chandasamādhīpadhānasāṅkhārasamannāgataṃ iddhipādaṃ bhāveti, viriyasamādhīpadhānasāṅkhārasamannāgataṃ iddhipādaṃ bhāveti, cittasamādhīpadhānasāṅkhārasamannāgataṃ iddhipādaṃ bhāveti, vīmaṃsāsamādhīpadhānasāṅkhārasamannāgataṃ iddhipādaṃ bhāveti. ime kho bho tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena cattāro iddhipādā paññattā iddhipahutāya iddhivisavitāya iddhivikubbanatāya. ye hi keci bho atītamaddhānaṃ samaṇā vā brāhmaṇā vā anekavihiṭṭaṃ iddhividhaṃ paccaṇubhosuṃ, sabbe te imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā. ye pi hi

keci bho anāgatamaddhānaṃ samaṇā vā brāhmaṇā  
vā anekavihiṭṭaṃ iddhi-vidhaṃ paccaṇubhossanti,  
sabbe te imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ  
bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā. yepi hi keci bho eta-  
rahi samaṇā vā brāhmaṇā vā anekavihiṭṭaṃ iddhi-  
vidhaṃ paccaṇubhonti sabbe te imesaṃ yeva ca-  
tunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā.

32. Do you, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, also see  
in me the ability to exercise such superhuman powers?

passanti no bhonto devā tāvatimsā mama pi maṃ  
evarūpaṃ iddhānubhāvanti?

33. “Yes, great Brahma.”

‘evaṃ mahābrahme’ti.

34. “It is only by the enculturation and the making  
habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers, Sirs,  
that I too, have become of such great power, of such  
great might.”

‘ahampi kho bho, imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhi-  
pādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā evaṃ mahid-  
dhiko evaṃmahānubhāvo’ti.

35. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma

Sanankumara spoke. Having spoken this meaning, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara addressed the Tavatimsa devas.

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhā-sittha. idamatthaṃ bhante brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsivā deve tāvatimse āmantesi.

36. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which these three achievements of an opening have been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure. Which three?

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā yāvañci-daṃ tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sam-māsambuddhena tayo okāsādhigamā anubuddhā sukhassa adhigamāya. katame tayo?

37. Here Sirs, a certain one dwells associated with sensual desires, associated with unwholesome dhammas. On a later occasion, he listens to the noble ones' Dhamma. He attends to the root source, and enters upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma. Owing to listening to the noble ones' Dhamma, attending to the root source, and entering upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma, he comes to dwell disassociated from sensual desires, disassociated from

unwholesome dhammas. For him being disassociated from sensual desires, disassociated from unwholesome dhammas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure advances mental pleasure. Just as, Sirs, gladness causes delight to be born. So too, Sirs, for him being disassociated from sensual desires, disassociated from unwholesome dhammas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure advances mental pleasure. This, Sirs, is the first achievement of an opening that has been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure.

idha bho ekacco saṃsaṭṭho viharati kāmehi, saṃsaṭṭho akusalehi dhammehi. so aparena samayena ariyadhammaṃ suṇāti, yoniso manasi karoti, dhammānudhammaṃ paṭipajjati. so ariyadhammasavanam āgama yonisomanasikāram dhammānudhammapaṭipattiṃ asaṃsaṭṭho viharati kāmehi, asaṃsaṭṭho akusalehi dhammehi. tassa asaṃsaṭṭhassa kāmehi asaṃsaṭṭhassa akusalehi dhammehi uppajjati sukham. sukhā bhiyyo somanassam. seyyathāpi bho mudā pāmojjaṃ jāyetha, evameva kho bho asaṃsaṭṭhassa kāmehi asaṃsaṭṭhassa akusalehi dhammehi uppajjati sukham. sukhā bhiyyo somanassam. ayam kho bho tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena paṭhamo okāsādhigamo anubuddho sukhasa adhigamāya.

38. Furthermore, Sirs, here, a certain one's coarse bodily sankharas are not allayed, his coarse verbal sankharas are not allayed, his coarse mental sankharas are not allayed. On a later occasion, he listens to the noble ones' Dhamma. He attends to the root source, and enters upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma. Owing to listening to the noble ones' Dhamma, attending to the root source, and entering upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma, his coarse bodily sankharas come to be allayed, his coarse verbal sankharas come to be allayed, his coarse mental sankharas come to be allayed. For him allaying his coarse bodily sankharas, allaying his coarse verbal sankharas, allaying his coarse mental sankharas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure advances mental pleasure. Just as, Sirs, gladness causes delight to be born. So too, Sirs, for him allaying his coarse bodily sankharas, allaying his coarse verbal sankharas, allaying his coarse mental sankharas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure advances mental pleasure. This, Sirs, is the second achievement of an opening that has been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure.

puna caparam bho, idhekaccassa oḷārikā kāya-saṅkhārā appaṭippassaddhā honti, oḷārikā vacī-saṅkhārā appaṭippassaddhā honti, oḷārikā citta-saṅkhārā appaṭippassaddhā honti, so aparena samayena ariyadhammaṃ suṇāti yoniso manasi ka-

roti dhammānudhammaṃ paṭipajjati. tassa ariyadhammasavanaṃ āgama yoniso manasikāraṃ dhammānudhammapaṭipattiṃ oḷārikā kāyasaṅkhārā paṭippassambhanti, oḷārikā vacīsaṅkhārā paṭippassambhanti, oḷārikā cittasaṅkhārā paṭippassambhanti. tassa oḷārikānaṃ kāyasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ vacīsaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ cittasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā uppajjati sukhaṃ. sukhā bhiyyo somanassaṃ. seyyathāpi bho, mudā pāmojjaṃ jāyetha. evameva kho bho oḷārikānaṃ kāyasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ vacīsaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ cittasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā uppajjati sukhaṃ. sukhā bhiyyo somanassaṃ. ayaṃ kho bho, tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena dutiyo okāsādhigamo anubuddho sukhasa adhigamāya.

39. Furthermore Sirs, here, a certain one does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is wholesome. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is unwholesome. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is blameworthy. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is blameless. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this should be associated with. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this should not be associated with. He does not wisely understand as it has come to

be, this is inferior. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is superior. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is dark, bright or their counterparts. On a later occasion, he listens to the noble ones' Dhamma. He attends to the root source, and enters upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma. Owing to listening to the noble ones' Dhamma, attending to the root source, and entering upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma, he wisely understands as it has come to be, this is wholesome. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is unwholesome. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is blameworthy. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is blameless. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this should be associated with. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this should not be associated with. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is inferior. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is superior. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is dark, bright or their counterparts. For him knowing thus, seeing thus, ignorance is abandoned, noble knowledge arises. From the fading away of ignorance and the arising of noble knowledge, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure advances mental pleasure. Just as, Sirs, gladness causes delight to be born. So too, Sirs, from the fading away of ignorance and the arising of noble knowledge, physical pleasure arises. This, Sirs, is the third achievement of an opening that has been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for



the attainment of pleasure.

puna caparaṃ bho, idhekacco idaṃ kusalanti ya-  
thābhūtaṃ nappajānāti. idaṃ akusalanti yathā-  
bhūtaṃ nappajānāti. idaṃ sāvajjaṃ idaṃ anava-  
jjaṃ idaṃ sevitabbaṃ idaṃ na sevitabbaṃ idaṃ  
hīnaṃ idaṃ paṇītaṃ idaṃ kaṇhasukkasappaṭibhā-  
ganti yathābhūtaṃ nappajānāti. so aparena sa-  
mayena ariyadhammaṃ suṇāti yoniso manasi ka-  
roti dhammānudhammaṃ paṭipajjati. so ariya-  
dhammasavanaṃ āgama yonisomanasikāraṃ dham-  
mānudhammappaṭipattiṃ idaṃ kusalanti yathā-  
bhūtaṃ pajānāti, idaṃ akusalanti yathābhūtaṃ  
pajānāti, idaṃ sāvajjaṃ idaṃ anavaajjaṃ idaṃ se-  
vitabbaṃ idaṃ na sevitabbaṃ idaṃ hīnaṃ idaṃ  
paṇītaṃ idaṃ kaṇhasukkasappaṭibhāganti yathā-  
bhūtaṃ pajānāti. tassa evaṃ jānato evaṃ pas-  
sato avijjā pahīyati, vijjā uppajjati. tassa avijjāvi-  
rāgā vijjuppādā uppajjati sukhaṃ, sukhā bhiyyo  
somanassaṃ. seyyathāpi bho, mudā pāmojjaṃ<sup>1</sup>  
jāyetha, evameva kho bho, avijjāvirāgā vijjuppādā  
uppajjati sukhaṃ sukhā bhiyyo somanassaṃ. ayaṃ  
kho bho, tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā  
sammāsambuddhena tatiyo okāsādhigamo anubud-  
dho sukhasa adhigamāya.

40. “These, Sirs, are the three achievements of an open-  
ing that have been awoken to by the Auspicious One who  
knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened

One, for the attainment of pleasure.”

ime kho bho, tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena tayo okāsādhigamā anubuddhā sukhassa adhigamāyāti.

41. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. Having spoken this meaning, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara addressed the Tavatimsa devas.

idamattham bhante, brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsīttha. idamattham bhante brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsītva deve tāvatimse āmantesi.

42. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the declaration of the four establishments of mindfulness has been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of the wholesome. Which four?

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā yāva supaññattācime tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena, cattāro satipaṭṭhānā kusalassādhigamāya. katame cattāro?

43. Here Sirs, having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in the body internally

perceiving in accordance with the body, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in the body internally perceiving in accordance with the body, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of the body of others externally.

idha bho, bhikkhu ajjhataṃ kāye kāyānupassī viharati ātāpī sampajāno satimā vineyya loke abhijjhādomanassaṃ. ajjhataṃ kāye kāyānupassī viharanto tattha sammā samādhīyati sammā vipasīdati. so tattha sammāsamāhito sammāvipasanno bahiddhā parakāye ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti.

44. Having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in feelings internally perceiving in accordance with feelings, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in feelings internally perceiving in accordance with feelings, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of feelings of others externally.

ajjhataṃ vedanāsu vedanānupassī viharati, -pebahiddhā paravedanāsu ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti.

45. Having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in states of mind internally perceiving in accordance with states of mind, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in states of mind internally perceiving in accordance with states of mind, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of states of mind of others externally.

ajjhataṃ citte cittānupassī viharati -pe- bahiddhā paracitte ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti.

46. Having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in dhammas internally perceiving in accordance with dhammas, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in dhammas internally perceiving in accordance with dhammas, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of dhammas of others externally. “These Sirs, are the four establishments of mindfulness that have been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of the wholesome.”

ajjhataṃ dhammesu dhammānupassī viharati ātāpī sampajāno satimā vineyya loke abhiññādomanasasam, ajjhataṃ dhammesu dhammānupassī viha-

ranto tattha sammā samādhīyati sammā vipassīdati. so tattha sammā samāhito sammā vipassanno bahiddhā paradhammesu ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti. ime kho bho, tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena cattāro satipaṭṭhānā paññattā kusalassa adhigamāyāti.

47. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. Having spoken this meaning, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara addressed the Tavatimsa devas.

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsīttha. idamatthaṃ bhante brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsītva deve tāvatimse āmantesi.

48. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the declaration of the seven requisites of right samadhi has been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the enculturation of right samadhi, for the fulfillment of right samadhi. Which seven?

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā yāvasupaññattācime tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambuddhena satta sammāsamāधि-parikkhārā sammāsamādhissa bhāvanāya sammāsamādhissa pāripūriyā. katame satta?

49. Right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness. That which, Sirs, is the unique loftiness of mind equipped with these seven factors, this is called, Sirs, noble right samadhi with its supports proper, with its requisites proper. In one of right view, Sirs, right thought comes into being. In one of right thought, right speech comes into being. In one of right speech, right action comes into being. In one of right action, right livelihood comes into being. In one of right livelihood, right effort comes into being. In one of right effort, right mindfulness comes into being. In one of right mindfulness, right samadhi comes into being. In one of right samadhi, right knowledge comes into being. In one of right knowledge, right liberation comes into being.

sammādiṭṭhi sammāsaṅkappo sammāvācā sammākammanto sammāājīvo sammāvāyāmo sammāsati. yā kho bho, imehi sattahi aṅgehi cittassa ekaggatā parikkhatā, ayaṃ vuccati bho, ariyo sammāsamādhi saupaniso itipi saparikkhāro itipi. sammādiṭṭhissa bho sammāsaṅkappo pahoti, sammāsaṅkappassa sammāvācā pahoti, sammāvācassa sammākammanto pahoti, sammākammantassa sammāājīvo pahoti, sammāājīvassa sammāvāyāmo pahoti, sammāvāyāmassa sammāsati pahoti, sammāsatiṣṭṭhissa sammāsamādhi pahoti, sammāsamādhissa sammāñāṇaṃ pahoti, sammāñāṇassa sammāvimutti pahoti.

50. Indeed, Sirs, that which one rightly saying would say: “The Dhamma is well-proclaimed by the Auspicious One, visible in this life, not involving time, inviting eye witness, leading onwards, to be comprehended by the wise, each one for one’s self, open is the door to the deathless,” it will be this here that one rightly saying, would say. For indeed “The Dhamma is well-proclaimed by the Auspicious One, visible in this life, not involving time, inviting eye witness, leading onwards, to be comprehended by the wise, each one for one’s self, open is the door to the deathless.”

yaṃ hi taṃ bho sammā vadamāno vadeyya, svākkhāto bhagavatā dhammo sandiṭṭhiko akāliko ehipassiko opānāyiko paccattaṃ veditabbo viññūhi apārutā amatassa dvārā ti, ida metaṃ sammā vadamāno vadeyya. svākkhāto hi bho, bhagavatā dhammo sandiṭṭhiko akāliko ehipassiko opānāyiko<sup>1</sup> paccattaṃ veditabbo viññūhi. apārutā amatassa dvārā ti.

51. Indeed whoever, Sirs, is endowed with confirmed confidence in the Buddha, endowed with confirmed confidence in the dhamma, endowed with confirmed confidence in the Sangha, endowed with the virtues dear to the noble ones. Those among these Magadhan disciples who had died and passed away, who have been born spontaneously on account of their Dhamma training, who, from the complete extinction of the three fetters,

are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening, amount to more than two million, four hundred thousand. There are also once returners among them.

ye hi keci bho, buddhe aveccappasādena saman-  
nāgatā, dhamme aveccappasādena samannāgatā,  
saṅghe aveccappasādena samannāgatā, ariyakan-  
tehi sīlehi samannāgatā. ye cime opapātikā dham-  
mavinītā sātirekāni catuvīsatisatasahassāni mā-  
gadhakā paricārakā abbhātītā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ  
saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipāta-  
dhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā. atthi ceve  
ttha sakadāgāmino.

But this other population,  
“[those] partaking in merits;”  
this mind of mine is not even able to calculate,  
for fear of uttering false speech.

atthāyaṃ<sup>48</sup> itarā pajā,  
puññabhāgāti me mano;  
saṅkhātuṃ no pi sakkomi,  
musāvādassa ottapanti.<sup>2</sup>

**53.** This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. As, O Bhante, the Brahma Sanankumara was speaking this meaning, for the great king Ves-savaṇa, a reflection of the mind arose thus: “Indeed it is marvellous Sir, indeed it is unprecedented, Sir, that there



will be such an excellent Teacher, also such an excellent proclamation of the Dhamma, and such an excellent attainment of distinction will be made evident.”

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro bhā-sittha. idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmuno sanāṃkumārassa bhāsato vessavaṇassa mahārājassa evaṃ cetaso parivitaṅko udapādi. ‘acchariyaṃ vata bho. abbhutaṃ vata bho, evarūpopi nāma ulāro satthā bhavissati, evarūpaṃ ulāraṃ dhammakkhānaṃ, evarūpā ulārā visesādhigamā paññāyissantī’ti.

54. So then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having known the reflection in the great king Vessavana’s mind with his own mind, said this to the great king Vessavana:

atha bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro vessavaṇassa mahārājassa cetasā ceto parivitaṅkamaññāya vessavaṇaṃ mahārājānaṃ etadavoca:

55. “What do you think about that, O great king Vessavana. In the past too there was such an excellent Teacher, also such an excellent proclamation of the Dhamma, and such an excellent attainment of distinction was made evident. In the future too there will be such an excellent Teacher, also such an excellent proclamation of the Dhamma, and such an excellent attainment of distinction will be made evident.”

“taṃ kimmaññati bhavaṃ vessavaṇo mahārājā. atī-  
tampi addhānaṃ evarūpo uḷāro satthā ahosi, eva-  
rūpaṃ uḷāraṃ dhammakkhānaṃ, evarūpā uḷārā  
viseśadhigamā paññāyimsu. anāgatampi addhā-  
naṃ evarūpo uḷāro satthā bhavissati. evarūpaṃ  
uḷāraṃ dhammakkhānaṃ, evarūpā uḷārā viseśa-  
dhigamā paññāyissantī”ti.

56. “This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke to the Tavatimsa devas. The great king Vessavana, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of Brahma Sanankumara speaking to the Tavatimsa devas, having received it in his presence, inform his own assembly. The Yakkha Janavasabha, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of the great king Vessavana’s assembly, having learned this in his presence, informed the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of the Yakkha Janavasabha, having received it in his presence, and also having known through supreme knowledge himself, informed the venerable Ananda. The venerable Ananda, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of the Auspicious One, having learned this in his presence, informed the bhikkhus, the bhikkhunis, the male lay disciples and the female lay disciples. So that this life of purity would be just prosperous and successful, well known and wide-spread, well taught among many people, among devas and humans.”

idamattham bhante, brahmā sanamkumāro devā-  
 nam tāvatimsānam abhāsi. idamattham vessa-  
 vaṇo mahārājā brahmuno sanamkumārassa de-  
 vānam tāvatimsānam bhāsato sammukhā sutam  
 sammukhā paṭiggahitam sayam parisāyam āro-  
 cesi. idamattham janavasabho yakkho vessava-  
 ṇassa mahārājassa sayam parisāyam bhāsato sam-  
 mukhā sutam sammukhā paṭiggahitam bhagavato  
 ārocesi. idamattham bhagavā janavasabhassa yak-  
 khassa sammukhā sutvā sammukhā paṭiggahetvā  
 sāmañca abhiññāya āyasmato ānandassa ārocesi.  
 idamattham āyasmā ānando bhagavato sammu-  
 khā sutvā sammukhā paṭiggahetvā ārocesi bhik-  
 khūnam bhikkhunīnam upāsakānam upāsikānam  
 ‘tayidaṃ brahmacariyaṃ iddhañceva phītañca vit-  
 thāritam bāhujaññaṃ puthubhūtam yāva devama-  
 nussehi suppakāsitanti.

